

Review 3

Speaking and Vocabulary

A Mark each of the following topics like this:

- (++) I can talk about this topic easily and have plenty to say.
 (+) I can talk about this topic quite well and have some things to say.
 (–) I don't enjoy talking about this topic and don't know what to say.

- | | | | |
|---------------------------------------|-----|--|-----|
| 1. keeping fit and doing exercise | ___ | 2. your diet | ___ |
| 3. the natural beauty of your country | ___ | 4. the climate and weather in your country | ___ |
| 5. your home | ___ | 6. your neighbourhood | ___ |
| 7. buildings in your country | ___ | 8. technology | ___ |
| 9. social issues | ___ | 10. crime | ___ |

B Discuss your answers with a partner.

C Work in pairs. Take it in turns to ask and answer questions about the topics in Exercise A.

D Write important words and phrases that you have learnt in Units 11–15 under each heading.

staying healthy

accidents and injuries

climate and weather

homes, houses and neighbourhoods

technology

my words and phrases

crime

social issues

Listening and Reading

A Work in pairs. Take it in turns to ask and answer the following questions about listening. The student asking the questions can look back at the unit and check the exam or question-type tips.

1. What type of information will you hear in the different parts of the listening exam?
2. Why is it sometimes easier to complete a flow chart or a table?
3. Will the speakers on the tape use formal or informal language?
4. Why might one speaker be more difficult to understand than another?
5. What do you need to do at the end of the listening exam?
6. How long do you have to transfer answers to the answer sheet?
7. What mistakes can you make when you are transferring answers?

B Work with the same partner. Ask and answer these questions about reading.

1. What do you remember about matching beginnings and endings of sentences? How can you make it easier to choose from a number of options?
2. How many different types of text can you remember? How can you know quickly what type of text you are reading?
3. Which passage is the longest passage? What type of text will it be?
4. What can you do to cope with a longer text more successfully?
5. Why is it important to time yourself when you read a text?
6. What is usually a waste of time when you are reading?
7. Why is it easier to write answers onto the question sheet during the reading exam than it is during the listening exam?

C Mark each of these statements (T) true or (F) false.

1. My listening has improved since I started the course. _____
2. I know what to listen for in order to answer questions. _____
3. I am happy writing answers as I continue to listen. _____
4. I am good at identifying key words even if I don't know them. _____
5. I feel confident about transferring answers in ten minutes. _____
6. My reading speed has improved since I began this course. _____
7. I feel confident reading any type of text now. _____
8. I understand the main idea of almost any text I read now. _____
9. I know what to look for in order to answer exam questions. _____
10. I don't worry about words and phrases I don't know anymore. _____

D Look at these comments that students have made about taking exams. Tick the ones that you most agree with.

- 'I get very nervous in exams. I can't concentrate on the tasks.' _____
- 'Some people are good at doing exams and some people are not.' _____
- 'If other students in the exam are writing a lot and seem to be doing well, it makes me anxious. I think I am not as good as they are.' _____
- 'My mind goes blank as soon as I sit down in an exam hall.' _____
- 'I worry too much about getting the answers right and not enough about whether I understand.' _____
- 'I can't sleep the night before an exam, so I'm always really tired during the exam.' _____
- 'Revising for exams is really boring.' _____
- 'Revising just before an exam is a waste of time. You either know it or you don't.' _____

Writing

- A** Look at the instructions for a writing task below. Highlight the key words and check that you understand what you have to do.

Write to a friend telling him/her that you are taking the IELTS exam. Say why you are taking the exam and how you feel about it. Tell your friend that he/she should do the exam and why.

Write at least 150 words. You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

- B** Look at this student's attempt to write the composition. Talk to a partner about what you like and don't like about the composition.

Hi Henri I'm Sorry that I didn't can come at your brothers weding last week I am very bisy resently. I'm taking an examination in english It called IELTS. I need it for go university next year. I just finish a course that help me prepare for this examination It dificult but I enjoy it too much. My speaking english is much better than before but I don't can write so good like can you see. Ha ha! The examination it is next friday and I am too nervos about it. There is a speaking part a lisening part a reading part and a writing part. The reading and writing parts is which I am nervos about. I think you should to take this IELTS examination too. Your good in english and so you can get high score I think it is good have this examination for find a work. ok goodby now William.

- C** Work in pairs. One of you is A, the other is B.

Student A: Highlight errors in the letter related to organization and grammar.

Student B: Highlight errors in the letter related to spelling and punctuation.

- D** Compare your ideas with a partner.

- E** Look at the version of the letter on page 274. The errors are highlighted. Then read the model letter below it.

- F** Write a similar letter to a friend of yours. Make sure you cover all the points in the instructions.

What next?

Congratulations! You've finished the course. You've heard the different types of talks or conversations that you will hear in the Listening Module and you've read the different types of text that you will have to read in the Reading Module. You've practised every task type for each module. Hopefully, you feel much more confident about taking the exam now. Here are some tips to prepare you for the exam.

- ✓ Revision doesn't have to be boring. It is boring if you do it for too long or try to do it all at once. It will make you feel anxious if you try to revise too much. Remember that revision means looking back at what you have learnt – not trying to learn things that you haven't learnt yet.
- ✓ Practise the Speaking Module with other students who are taking the exam. Revise the typical vocabulary that you need to talk about the most common topics of conversation. Make sure you know the words and phrases you need to talk about your own life.
- ✓ Revise for the Listening Module by borrowing tapes that practise IELTS listening tasks. Remember, though, that the important thing is to improve your all-round listening skills, so continue to follow the advice from the previous review sections.
- ✓ Revise for the Reading Module by doing reading sections from past IELTS papers and by doing the IELTS mock exams in this book. Look back at the Reading Modules from earlier units in this book. Look at how the texts have become more challenging and how your reading skills have improved.
- ✓ Revise when you would otherwise be wasting time. Revise at the bus stop or on the bus. Don't wait until the night before the exam to do all your revision. Remember that the important thing is to improve your all-round reading skills, so continue to follow the advice from the previous review sections.
- ✓ Practise writing compositions and ask your teacher or someone who reads English very well to check them. Continue to look at as many model answers to exam questions as you can.
- ✓ Try to get a good night's sleep the night before the exam. You don't want to feel tired. Make sure you arrive at the exam centre some time before the exam starts. You want to feel relaxed and confident – not in a terrible rush.
- ✓ Try not to be nervous. Remember that the important thing is to understand what you hear and what you read. If you can, you will answer questions correctly. Don't worry about how other people are doing – you are not in competition with them.